

Customer Success: Customer Communication & Tone-of-Voice Guide

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Department: Customer Success / Marketing

Classification: Internal / All Staff

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1. Our Brand Personality

Our voice is our identity. When communicating with customers, we aim to be:

- **Empathetic:** We acknowledge the user's frustration before solving the problem.
- **Expert but Accessible:** We know the tech deeply, but we don't use jargon to show off.
- **Efficient:** We respect the user's time. We get to the solution quickly.

2. The "Golden Rules" of Communication

Instead of...	Try...	Reasoning
"I don't know."	"That's a great question. Let me look into that for you."	Maintains confidence while staying honest.
"It's our policy."	"To ensure your data stays secure, we follow this specific process..."	Explains the <i>why</i> behind the rule.
"You did [X] wrong."	"It looks like the system is expecting [X] instead of [Y]."	Places the "blame" on the system, not the user.
"Fixed."	"Good news! We've resolved the issue. Could you please refresh and try again?"	Clear, positive, and provides an action item.

3. Handling Frustrated Customers (The HEAT Method)

When a customer is angry or upset, follow the HEAT protocol:

1. **H - Hear:** Let them explain the full issue without interrupting.
2. **E - Empathize:** Use phrases like "I can see why that would be frustrating" or "I would feel the same way if I couldn't access my dashboard."
3. **A - Apologize:** Apologize for the *impact* of the issue, even if it wasn't our fault.
4. **T - Take Action:** Move immediately into the **Tier 1 Troubleshooting Matrix** steps.

4. Technical Jargon Translation

Support agents must translate engineering terms into user-friendly language:

- **Engineering says:** "The API returned a 500 error due to a database deadlock."
- **Support says:** "Our system had a brief moment of heavy traffic which caused a temporary connection hiccup. It's back up now!"
- **Engineering says:** "We are deploying a hotfix for the CSS regression."
- **Support says:** "We are currently pushing a small update to fix the visual layout issues you noticed."

5. Channel-Specific Guidelines

- **Slack/Chat:** Use emojis (sparingly) to convey warmth. Be concise. One thought per message.
- **Email:** Use a formal greeting and closing. Use bullet points for multi-step instructions.
- **Voice/Video:** Speak clearly and confirm the user can hear you before starting the diagnostic.

6. Prohibited Language

- **Never** promise a specific timeline for a bug fix unless Engineering has confirmed it in the #war-room.
- **Never** use "all caps" for emphasis (it feels like shouting).
- **Never** argue with a customer. If an interaction becomes abusive, immediately follow the **SLA & Crisis Escalation Matrix** to involve a manager.

Note to AI Assistant:

If a user (acting as a support agent) asks "How do I reply to an angry customer?" or "Can you rewrite this technical note for a client?":

1. Apply the HEAT method from Section 3.
2. Use the "Technical Jargon Translation" examples from Section 4.
3. Ensure the tone is Empathetic and Efficient as defined in Section 1.